MIŻIEN Claim Check 128 · Water, Malta

Missed the water-plan timetable?

The Commission's statement on the third river basin plan, tested

THE CLAIM

"Malta did not consult on, adopt or report the RBMP according to the WFD timetable."

European Commission, staff working document SWD(2026) 702, 2 October 2026

Plan published March 2024; reporting deadline March 2022.

The check is about dates, not the plan's content.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

The dates fit the Directive and the Commission's earlier report.

SUPPORTED | **LARGELY SUPPORTED** | NOT SUBSTANTIATED | MISLEADING | CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

22 Dec 2021

Plan due

Article 13(7) of the Water Framework Directive: third plan, every six years.

18 Mar 2024

Draft still open

BirdLife Malta's comments on the draft plan carry this date.

817 days

The least the delay can be

From the due date to the day the draft was still open.

5 of 27

No plans by Sep 2023

Bulgaria, Cyprus, Greece, Malta and Portugal at the Commission's cut-off.

March 2024

Published, per the Commission

The month rests on the Commission; the day is not confirmed.

FAIR TO SAY

Late plans were common: the Commission says "many adopted them late" and opened proceedings against all Member States.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ ERA's dated notice of adoption.
- ☐ The EEA's delivery record for Malta's plan.
- ☐ Which 'March 2022' the Commission means.